

Chapter 34 - Part 1

Liang Shi's relationship with Little Bell wasn't good.

To be precise, Liang Shi didn't used to like children. When they got married, Little Bell was a flower girl. Upon seeing her, Little Bell was always timid and didn't dare approach to talk to Xu Qingzhu.

During the meal, Little Bell sat at the same table as Xu Qingzhu, and Xu Qingzhu kept taking care of her.

Only then did Little Bell let down her guard a little. But when the little girl wanted to eat shrimp and couldn't peel it, she would glance at Liang Shi before trying to take shrimp from the plate. It was Xu Qingzhu who peeled several shrimp for her to eat.

Xu Qingzhu had once said to Liang Shi: "Don't be so fierce, you'll scare the children."

Liang Shi frowned and replied indifferently: "With such a small courage, she deserves to be scared."

Children are mischievous. At the wedding venue, running around everywhere, she accidentally tripped over a wire and fell to the ground, hitting her knee and crying loudly in pain.

Liang Shi picked her up from the ground in one motion, with a disgusted expression and some impatience: "How annoying."

Anyone could tell that wasn't a worried complaint, but genuine annoyance.

And Liang Shi did all this when Liang Xinhe¹ and his wife weren't around. When Little Bell saw her parents, she would show concern and ask about her well-being, and even when she was really on the verge of an emotional breakdown, she would try her best to endure it.

But children are the most sensitive to changes in adults' emotions.

Especially little girls of this age are particularly emotionally sensitive.

So Little Bell had always been quite afraid of her, let alone taking the initiative to come play with her.

In just a few short days, what exactly had happened?

Xu Qingzhu looked at Liang Shi, who was holding Little Bell's hand, crouching down to chat with her at eye level, asking in a gentle voice: "Have you had breakfast?"

"I have! The nanny aunt made seafood porridge." Little Bell answered in her sweet, childish voice.

"Good." Liang Shi said: "Let's say goodbye to Mommy first, then we can go play games, okay?"

"Okay!" Little Bell tilted her head, revealing a small canine tooth when she smiled, then turned to wave at her mother: "Goodbye Mommy, be careful on the road, come pick me up tonight!"

"Mm-hmm, then you must be good with Auntie and Aunt-in-law, you can't eat ice cream today, and you can't let Auntie buy you toys." Sun Meirou² gently reminded her: "Mommy will come back early."

"It's okay, Grandma is important!" Little Bell said: "You have to tell Grandma that I miss her!"

Sun Meirou laughed softly: "I know."

Liang Shi was discussing with Little Bell what they should play later, while Xu Qingzhu said to Sun Meirou: "Second Sister-in-law, I'll take good care of Little Bell, don't worry."

"Thank you, younger sister-in-law." Sun Meirou said, then suddenly leaned closer and whispered: "Last time when Third Sister came home, I felt like she had become a different person, she was patient with Little Bell. When there was nothing to do at the old mansion, she kept playing with Little Bell, so this time when I needed to go back to my mother's house, she insisted on coming to your place to play. I couldn't do anything about it."

"It's fine." Xu Qingzhu said: "It's Sunday today anyway, we both have time."

"Mm." Sun Meirou paused, then looked at Xu Qingzhu's lower abdomen: "Younger sister-in-law..."

She hesitated to speak.

Xu Qingzhu asked: "Second Sister-in-law, what's wrong?"

Sun Meirou smiled: "Nothing."

But her gaze toward Xu Qingzhu's abdomen was too obvious. Xu Qingzhu immediately said: "Second Sister-in-law, I'm not pregnant."

Sun Meirou: "..."

She smiled awkwardly: "I thought it was because you were pregnant, so Third Sister started liking children."

Xu Qingzhu was also helpless, but didn't expose Liang Shi in front of Sun Meirou, only saying: "Maybe it's because she's grown up. She has indeed become much better recently."

"That's good." Sun Meirou chatted about family matters: "People often say 'marry a virtuous wife' - having a good wife means half of life's success. Third Sister used to be spoiled too much by mother-in-law, but now she's much better. This is all your achievement."

Xu Qingzhu: "...?"

How could she dare take credit?

"Maybe it's because she's reached the right age." Xu Qingzhu deflected: "She probably realized that if she continues being spoiled, no one will indulge her anymore."

"No matter what, this is quite good." Sun Meirou looked at her watch: "It's getting late, I should go. Little Bell will be in your care for the day. In the future, if you two have children, I'll help you take care of them."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

She coughed lightly and smiled awkwardly: "Alright Second Sister-in-law, be careful on the road."

Footnotes:

¹ Liang Xinhe: Liang Shi's second brother

² Sun Meirou: Liang Xinhe's wife, Little Bell's mother